How to mix the colour and its shades

In painting, green is made by mixing yellow and blue. **The result, however, depends on the particular colours.** Two different blues with the same yellow can make quite different greens. A warmer blue with a hint of green is usually easier for a fresh mix than a blue with a strongly violet tint. The proportions are approximate and every brand behaves a little differently, so try them out on paper first.

What to prepare



Yellow

Brings a lighter, yellower and more springlike form of green.



Blue

Pushes it towards a cooler, deeper and bluer green.



White

Lightens it and creates mint and pastel tones.



Red

Its opposite on the colour wheel, in a small amount it calms green.



Brown

Helps with olive, moss and earthy shades.



Ochre

Gentler earthy tones, suitable for olive and khaki.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

A yellower green may recall freshly mown grass or lime, a bluer one a pine forest or sea water. The names on tubes differ between makers, so put **small samples** side by side and **add white** to part of them. You will then see the tint better.

On the tube look for the marking **PG** (Pigment Green) and a number. It tells you which pigment it is, even when the name differs. In green mixtures you will often also see **PY** and **PB**, that is the yellow and blue pigments the colour is mixed from.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens and pushes towards mint and pastel. Add it little by little.





Yellow

Leads to fresh, springlike and yellow-green tones.





Blue

Leads to blue-green, emerald and bottle green. A strong blue, add it carefully.





Red

Mutes it. A bigger dose pulls it towards brown-green and grey-green.





Brown

Earthy, forest tones. Moss and bark.





Ochre

Gentler earthy tones, olive and khaki.



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Ten greens to try

A part can be a drop, or a pile of paint of the same size. **Take the proportions as a starting point for trying things out**, not as a recipe for a cake.

Basic green

2 parts yellow + 1 part blue. Balanced, natural. Add the blue in small portions, it easily takes over.

Lime

4 parts lemon yellow + blue on the tip of the brush. Juicy, fresh, cheeky.

Spring yellow-green

1 part basic green + 1 part yellow, a little white if needed. Young leaves, the first spring.

Grass green

2 parts basic green + 1 part yellow. A meadow after rain. If it is too yellow, bring it back with a tiny trace of blue.

Bottle green

3 parts basic green + about 1 part dark blue. Deep, calm. A strong phthalo blue may need only the tip of the brush.

Olive

2 parts yellow ochre + a small amount of green, gradually. Earthy, warm. If it is too lively, try a dot of red.

Khaki

Start with olive and add a little brown, or white if you like. Brown grounds it, white lightens it.

Sage

3 parts white + 1 part green + a really small dot of red. Red mutes the saturation, try it first on the edge of the palette.

Mint

4 parts white + 1 part green + a dot of blue. Cool, fresh. Blue quickly pushes it towards turquoise.

Blue-green

2 parts basic green + gradually up to 1 part blue. If the blue is too strong, much less will do.

Light sea green

3 parts white + 1 part blue-green. Clean, airy. A drop of yellow brings it back to greener.

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